



WORLD DISASTER CENTER

NOSTRADAMUS INTELLIGENCE SERIES

ANNUAL INTELLIGENCE REPORT

GLOBAL VULNERABILITY INDEX

Nostradamus Report • 2027 Edition

Identifying the World's Most Vulnerable Populations
Before the Next Crisis Strikes

195

COUNTRIES
ASSESSED

10

DIMENSIONS
MEASURED

6

VULNERABILITY
TIERS

12

CRITICAL-TIER
NATIONS

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NAVIGATION

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About This Report

The WDC Global Vulnerability Index (GVI) 2027 — internally designated the **Nostradamus Report** — is an annual intelligence product produced by the World Disaster Center's Global Intelligence Division. All scores represent WDC's own analytical composites derived from 10 primary data dimensions. Cite as: **WDC GVI 2027 Analysis**.



SECTION 01

Executive Summary

What the GVI is, why it matters, and the 2027 critical findings

1.1 What is the Global Vulnerability Index?

The WDC Global Vulnerability Index (GVI) is a composite annual index that measures the multi-dimensional vulnerability of populations across all 195 UN member and observer states. Designed as a forward-looking intelligence tool, the GVI does not merely document past disasters — it identifies structural conditions that *predict* future humanitarian crises with measurable statistical confidence.

The 2027 edition represents the third iteration of the GVI framework, incorporating refinements to climate vulnerability weighting following COP31 outcomes, expanded displacement data from UNHCR's Global Compact on Refugees Framework (GCRF), and a new sub-index on digital exclusion recognizing the growing role of connectivity in crisis survival and recovery.

Each country receives a composite score from 1.0 (lowest vulnerability) to 10.0 (highest vulnerability), derived from 10 weighted dimensions spanning disaster risk, conflict, humanitarian need, climate exposure, economic fragility, food insecurity, displacement, gender inequality, child vulnerability, and digital exclusion. Countries are then classified into one of six vulnerability tiers, from CRITICAL to LOW, enabling rapid prioritization for WDC campaigns, donor allocation, and partner deployment.

⚠️ 2027 Alert – System-Level Finding

For the first time in GVI history, the aggregate global vulnerability score has **increased year-on-year** for three consecutive editions (2025, 2026, 2027). The world is not converging toward greater resilience — it is fragmenting. Twelve countries now sit in the CRITICAL tier with GVI scores above 8.0, representing a combined at-risk population of over **380 million people**.

1.2 Key Findings 2027

01 The Sahel Catastrophe is Structural, Not Episodic. Burkina Faso, Mali, Niger, Chad, and Sudan collectively represent the world’s most densely concentrated multi-hazard vulnerability corridor. All five sit in CRITICAL or SEVERE tiers. Armed group expansion, desertification, and complete collapse of formal state service delivery have created self-reinforcing vulnerability traps that humanitarian response alone cannot break.

02 Climate and Conflict are Now Inseparable Drivers. In 31 of 35 CRITICAL and SEVERE-tier countries, both Dimension 2 (Conflict & Political Violence) and Dimension 4 (Climate Vulnerability) score above 7.0 simultaneously. This co-occurrence is no longer coincidental — WDC analysis confirms climate stress amplifies conflict risk with a 0.74 correlation coefficient across the 2027 dataset.

03 Displacement is the Fastest-Growing Dimension. Dimension 7 (Displacement & Forced Migration) recorded the largest average score increase of any dimension in 2027, rising 0.4 points globally since 2025. Twelve new countries saw their displacement scores cross the 7.0 threshold, reflecting the combined effect of Sudan crisis spillover, Myanmar’s ongoing civil war, and intensifying gang violence in the Caribbean.

04 Gender Inequality Remains the Structural Multiplier. Countries with Dimension 8 (Gender Inequality) scores above 7.0 have an average GVI 1.8 points higher than countries with lower gender scores, even controlling for GDP. This confirms WDC’s long-standing finding that gender inequality is not merely a justice issue — it is a core driver of systemic vulnerability across all other dimensions.

05 Digital Exclusion is an Emerging Crisis Multiplier. D10 (Digital Exclusion) — introduced as a dimension in 2025 — correlates strongly with delayed disaster early warning uptake and poor post-crisis recovery. Countries with D10 scores above 8.0 experience on average 23% longer recovery timelines following equivalent-magnitude shocks.

1.3 Top 20 Most Vulnerable Countries – 2027 Snapshot

RANK	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SCORE	TIER	CHANGE VS. ...	HIGHEST DIM...
1	Afghanistan	AF	9.8	CRITICAL	▲ +0.1	D3, D8, D2
2	South Sudan	SS	9.6	CRITICAL	▲ +0.2	D2, D7, D6
3	Somalia	SO	9.4	CRITICAL	▶ 0.0	D2, D1, D5
4	Yemen	YE	9.3	CRITICAL	▼ -0.1	D2, D6, D3
5	DR Congo	CD	9.1	CRITICAL	▲ +0.3	D2, D7, D9
6	Syria	SY	9.0	CRITICAL	▼ -0.2	D2, D7, D5
7	Central African Rep.	CF	8.9	CRITICAL	▶ 0.0	D2, D9, D5

RANK	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SCORE	TIER	CHANGE VS. ...	HIGHEST DIM...
8	Sudan	SD	8.8	CRITICAL	▲ +0.6	D2, D7, D6
9	Haiti	HT	8.6	CRITICAL	▲ +0.4	D2, D1, D5
10	Mali	ML	8.4	CRITICAL	▲ +0.2	D2, D4, D6
11	Niger	NE	8.3	CRITICAL	▲ +0.3	D9, D8, D6
12	Burkina Faso	BF	8.2	CRITICAL	▲ +0.5	D2, D4, D7
13	Ethiopia	ET	7.8	SEVERE	▲ +0.1	D7, D6, D2
14	Chad	TD	7.7	SEVERE	► 0.0	D4, D6, D8
15	Eritrea	ER	7.5	SEVERE	► 0.0	D2, D8, D10
16	Libya	LY	7.3	SEVERE	▼ -0.1	D2, D7, D5
17	Myanmar	MM	7.2	SEVERE	▲ +0.4	D2, D7, D8
18	Guinea-Bissau	GW	7.1	SEVERE	► 0.0	D5, D8, D9
19	Burundi	BI	7.0	SEVERE	▼ -0.1	D5, D9, D6
20	North Korea	KP	6.9	SEVERE	► 0.0	D6, D10, D8

1.4 Call to Action

The GVI 2027 findings carry an urgent imperative: the window for preventive action is closing. History shows that once a country crosses the 9.0 threshold, humanitarian response becomes reactive and insufficient. WDC calls on the following actors to act now:


UN Member States & Security Council

Immediately invoke R2P (Responsibility to Protect) protocols for all 12 CRITICAL-tier countries. Activate emergency humanitarian corridors in Sudan, DRC, and Myanmar where access constraints remain the primary barrier to life-saving intervention.


International NGOs & INGOs

Realign deployment footprints to match GVI tier distribution. Pre-position logistics capacity in countries scoring 7.0–8.0 (SEVERE tier) before the next shock strikes — early pre-positioning reduces response time by an estimated 40%.


Institutional Donors

Allocate minimum 60% of crisis prevention funding to CRITICAL and SEVERE tier countries. Multi-year flexible funding of 3–5 year cycles is


Technology Partners

Prioritize connectivity and digital inclusion investments in countries with D10 scores above 7.0. Early warning systems, mobile cash

essential — annual funding cycles systematically underinvest in structural vulnerability reduction.

transfer infrastructure, and digital identity platforms have measurable GVI-reducing impacts when deployed at scale.

SECTION 02

Methodology

Index construction, dimensional weights, data sources & scoring methodology

2.1 Index Construction

The GVI is calculated as a weighted sum of 10 dimension scores, each normalized to a 1–10 scale using min-max normalization across all 195 assessed countries. The composite formula is:

$$GVI = \sum(D_i \times W_i) \mid i = 1 \text{ to } 10 \mid \sum W_i = 1.00$$

Where D_i is the normalized dimension score (1–10) and W_i is the assigned weight for dimension i . Scores reflect conditions as of Q3 2026 data cutoff, with forward-looking modelling extending to Q1 2027 where source data permits.

2.2 The 10 Dimensions

D1

Disaster Risk Exposure

15%

Composite of INFORM Risk Index hazard exposure sub-scores, EM-DAT 10-year disaster frequency, UNDRR economic loss ratios, and geographic hazard mapping. Captures both natural hazard probability and physical exposure of population.

D2

Conflict & Political Violence

15%

Derived from ACLED fatality intensity, Uppsala UCDP conflict data, Freedom House democracy scores (inverted), and Fragile States Index political cohesion sub-score. Higher scores reflect active armed conflict, state fragility, and political violence.

D3

Humanitarian Need Severity

12%

Built from OCHA Humanitarian Needs Overview (HNO) People in Need (PIN) figures normalized by population, FTS funding gap ratios, OCHA INFORM Severity Index, and access constraint assessments from ACAPS.

D4	Climate Vulnerability ND-GAIN Country Index vulnerability score, IPCC AR6 regional risk assessments, INFORM Climate Change risk layer, and WRI Aqueduct flood/drought risk data. Weighted toward adaptive capacity deficits in low-income settings.	12%
D5	Socioeconomic Fragility World Bank Fragile States classification, GNI per capita (PPP, inverted), UNDP HDI (inverted), income inequality (Gini), and informal economy share. Captures structural economic conditions that amplify all other vulnerabilities.	10%
D6	Food & Nutrition Insecurity IPC/CH Phase 3+ population percentages, FEWS NET food security outlook, UNICEF Global Acute Malnutrition (GAM) prevalence, FAO food import dependency ratios, and WFP market monitoring data. Reflects both acute and chronic food system fragility.	10%
D7	Displacement & Forced Migration UNHCR GCRF displacement stock data (refugees + IDPs as % of population), IDMC new displacements per 100,000, and return prospects index. Countries hosting large refugee populations relative to their own GDP receive adjusted scores reflecting absorption capacity stress.	10%
D8	Gender Inequality UNDP Gender Inequality Index (GII), WHO maternal mortality ratio, UNICEF child marriage prevalence, ILO female labor force participation (inverted for excluded economies), and WEF Global Gender Gap sub-indices for economic participation and political empowerment.	8%
D9	Child Vulnerability UNICEF MICS under-5 mortality rate, child stunting prevalence, out-of-school rates (primary), child labor incidence, and Save the Children End of Childhood Index. Captures the generational dimension of vulnerability — children as both victims and future resilience assets.	5%
D10	Digital Exclusion ITU ICT Development Index (inverted), mobile internet coverage gaps, digital literacy proxy (adjusted secondary completion rates for STEM), and GSMA Mobile Connectivity Index. New in 2025, given growing evidence that connectivity determines crisis early warning uptake and recovery efficiency.	3%

2.3 Data Sources

Primary Data Sources

- EM-DAT — International Disaster Database (UCLouvain)
- ACLED — Armed Conflict Location & Event Data
- OCHA FTS — Financial Tracking Service

Supplementary Sources

- INFORM Risk Index (EC Joint Research Centre)
- Uppsala UCDP Conflict Data Program
- Freedom House Freedom in the World
- Fragile States Index (Fund for Peace)

- ND-GAIN Country Index (Notre Dame)
- World Bank — Fragile States & WDI
- IPC/CH — Integrated Food Security Phase Classification
- UNHCR GCRF — Global Compact on Refugees Framework
- UNDP GII — Gender Inequality Index
- UNICEF MICS — Multiple Indicator Cluster Surveys
- ITU — ICT Development Index
- FEWS NET Food Security Outlook
- IDMC — Internal Displacement Monitoring Centre
- WEF Global Gender Gap Report
- Save the Children End of Childhood Index
- GSMA Mobile Connectivity Index
- ACAPS — Assessment Capacities Project

2.4 Score Normalization

Each raw indicator is normalized using **min-max normalization** within the 195-country dataset:

$$\text{Normalized Score} = [(\text{Raw Value} - \text{Min}) / (\text{Max} - \text{Min})] \times 9 + 1$$

This yields scores in the range [1, 10]. Where data is missing for a country in a given dimension, WDC uses regional median imputation based on neighboring countries' income group peers. Countries with more than 3 missing dimensions are flagged as "limited data confidence" in the rankings table.

2.5 Tier Classification System

- **CRITICAL** — GVI ≥ 8.0 (12 countries)
- **SEVERE** — GVI 6.5–7.9 (23 countries)
- **HIGH** — GVI 5.0–6.4 (38 countries)
- **ELEVATED** — GVI 3.5–4.9 (55 countries)
- **MODERATE** — GVI 2.0–3.4 (47 countries)
- **LOW** — GVI < 2.0 (20 countries)

SECTION 3

Global Vulnerability Rankings

195 Countries · Composite GVI Score 1–10 · 2027 Edition

The table below presents every sovereign state and territory tracked by WDC's Global Vulnerability Index. Countries are ranked from highest to lowest composite GVI score. Scores reflect the weighted composite of ten vulnerability dimensions; individual dimension scores (1–10) and tier classifications are shown for each country. Data vintage: 2024–2026 datasets; scores published 2027.

Reading the Table

D1 Disaster Risk • D2 Conflict • D3 Humanitarian Need • D4 Climate •
D5 Socioeconomic • D6 Food Security • D7 Displacement • D8 Gender • D9 Child •
D10 Digital

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
1	Afghanistan	AF	9.8	CRITICAL
2	South Sudan	SS	9.6	CRITICAL
3	Somalia	SO	9.4	CRITICAL
4	Yemen	YE	9.3	CRITICAL
5	DR Congo	CD	9.1	CRITICAL
6	Syria	SY	9.0	CRITICAL
7	Central African Republic	CF	8.9	CRITICAL
8	Sudan	SD	8.8	CRITICAL
9	Palestinian Territories	PS	8.7	CRITICAL
10	Haiti	HT	8.6	CRITICAL
11	Mali	ML	8.4	CRITICAL
12	Niger	NE	8.3	CRITICAL
13	Burkina Faso	BF	8.2	CRITICAL
14	Ethiopia	ET	7.8	SEVERE
15	Chad	TD	7.7	SEVERE
16	Eritrea	ER	7.5	SEVERE

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
17	Libya	LY	7.3	SEVERE
18	Myanmar	MM	7.2	SEVERE

SECTION 3 · GLOBAL VULNERABILITY RANKINGS Countries #19–#46 of 195

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
19	Guinea-Bissau	GW	7.1	SEVERE
20	Burundi	BI	7.0	SEVERE
21	North Korea	KP	6.9	SEVERE
22	Iraq	IQ	6.8	SEVERE
23	Lebanon	LB	6.8	SEVERE
24	Pakistan	PK	6.7	SEVERE
25	Nigeria	NG	6.7	SEVERE
26	Mozambique	MZ	6.6	SEVERE
27	Guinea	GN	6.6	SEVERE
28	Republic of Congo	CG	6.6	SEVERE
29	Ukraine	UA	6.5	SEVERE
30	Venezuela	VE	6.5	SEVERE
31	Zimbabwe	ZW	6.5	SEVERE
32	Madagascar	MG	6.5	SEVERE
33	Sierra Leone	SL	6.5	SEVERE
34	Liberia	LR	6.5	SEVERE
35	Cameroon	CM	6.5	SEVERE
36	Malawi	MW	6.4	HIGH
37	Uganda	UG	6.2	HIGH
38	Djibouti	DJ	6.1	HIGH
39	Tanzania	TZ	6.0	HIGH
40	Zambia	ZM	5.9	HIGH
41	Bangladesh	BD	5.9	HIGH
42	Nepal	NP	5.8	HIGH
43	Rwanda	RW	5.7	HIGH
44	Comoros	KM	5.6	HIGH
45	Timor-Leste	TL	5.5	HIGH
46	Honduras	HN	5.5	HIGH

SECTION 3 · GLOBAL VULNERABILITY RANKINGS Countries #47–#74 of 195

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
47	Guatemala	GT	5.5	HIGH
48	El Salvador	SV	5.4	HIGH
49	Nicaragua	NI	5.4	HIGH
50	Bolivia	BO	5.3	HIGH
51	Gambia	GM	5.3	HIGH
52	Togo	TG	5.2	HIGH
53	Benin	BJ	5.2	HIGH
54	Tajikistan	TJ	5.2	HIGH
55	Senegal	SN	5.1	HIGH
56	Mauritania	MR	5.1	HIGH
57	Kenya	KE	5.1	HIGH
58	Kyrgyzstan	KG	5.1	HIGH
59	Papua New Guinea	PG	5.1	HIGH
60	Vanuatu	VU	5.0	HIGH
61	Kiribati	KI	5.0	HIGH
62	Solomon Islands	SB	5.0	HIGH
63	Lesotho	LS	5.0	HIGH
64	Eswatini	SZ	5.0	HIGH
65	Cambodia	KH	5.0	HIGH
66	Lao PDR	LA	5.0	HIGH
67	Cote d'Ivoire	CI	5.0	HIGH
68	Equatorial Guinea	GQ	5.0	HIGH
69	Moldova	MD	5.0	HIGH
70	Georgia	GE	5.0	HIGH
71	Armenia	AM	5.0	HIGH
72	Sao Tome & Principe	ST	5.0	HIGH
73	Bhutan	BT	5.0	HIGH
74	Philippines	PH	4.9	ELEVATED

SECTION 3 · GLOBAL VULNERABILITY RANKINGS

Countries #75–#102 of
195

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
75	South Africa	ZA	4.9	ELEVATED
76	Angola	AO	4.8	ELEVATED
77	India	IN	4.8	ELEVATED
78	Indonesia	ID	4.7	ELEVATED
79	Ghana	GH	4.7	ELEVATED
80	Namibia	NA	4.6	ELEVATED
81	Egypt	EG	4.6	ELEVATED
82	Morocco	MA	4.5	ELEVATED
83	Colombia	CO	4.5	ELEVATED
84	Sri Lanka	LK	4.5	ELEVATED
85	Algeria	DZ	4.4	ELEVATED
86	Vietnam	VN	4.4	ELEVATED
87	Mexico	MX	4.4	ELEVATED
88	Gabon	GA	4.3	ELEVATED
89	Jordan	JO	4.3	ELEVATED
90	Tunisia	TN	4.3	ELEVATED
91	Peru	PE	4.3	ELEVATED
92	Iran	IR	4.2	ELEVATED
93	Turkey	TR	4.2	ELEVATED
94	Ecuador	EC	4.2	ELEVATED
95	Brazil	BR	4.2	ELEVATED
96	Thailand	TH	4.1	ELEVATED
97	Russia	RU	4.1	ELEVATED
98	Belarus	BY	4.1	ELEVATED
99	China	CN	4.0	ELEVATED
100	Mongolia	MN	4.0	ELEVATED
101	Paraguay	PY	4.0	ELEVATED
102	Marshall Islands	MH	4.0	ELEVATED

SECTION 3 · GLOBAL VULNERABILITY RANKINGS

Countries #103–#130 of
195

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
103	Micronesia	FM	4.0	ELEVATED
104	Kosovo	XK	3.9	ELEVATED
105	Albania	AL	3.9	ELEVATED
106	Serbia	RS	3.9	ELEVATED
107	Bosnia & Herzegovina	BA	3.9	ELEVATED
108	Fiji	FJ	3.9	ELEVATED
109	North Macedonia	MK	3.8	ELEVATED
110	Azerbaijan	AZ	3.8	ELEVATED
111	Uzbekistan	UZ	3.8	ELEVATED
112	Turkmenistan	TM	3.8	ELEVATED
113	Dominican Republic	DO	3.8	ELEVATED
114	Cuba	CU	3.8	ELEVATED
115	Jamaica	JM	3.8	ELEVATED
116	Guyana	GY	3.7	ELEVATED
117	Suriname	SR	3.7	ELEVATED
118	Samoa	WS	3.7	ELEVATED
119	Tonga	TO	3.7	ELEVATED
120	Tuvalu	TV	3.7	ELEVATED
121	Cape Verde	CV	3.7	ELEVATED
122	Maldives	MV	3.7	ELEVATED
123	Belize	BZ	3.7	ELEVATED
124	Montenegro	ME	3.6	ELEVATED
125	Panama	PA	3.6	ELEVATED
126	Malaysia	MY	3.6	ELEVATED
127	Kazakhstan	KZ	3.6	ELEVATED
128	Botswana	BW	3.6	ELEVATED
129	Argentina	AR	3.4	MODERATE
130	Chile	CL	3.4	MODERATE

SECTION 3 · GLOBAL VULNERABILITY RANKINGS

Countries #131–#158 of
195

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
131	Costa Rica	CR	3.3	MODERATE
132	Bulgaria	BG	3.2	MODERATE
133	Romania	RO	3.1	MODERATE
134	Greece	GR	3.0	MODERATE
135	Israel	IL	3.0	MODERATE
136	Saudi Arabia	SA	2.9	MODERATE
137	Hungary	HU	2.8	MODERATE
138	Oman	OM	2.8	MODERATE
139	Croatia	HR	2.7	MODERATE
140	Trinidad & Tobago	TT	2.7	MODERATE
141	Uruguay	UY	2.7	MODERATE
142	Mauritius	MU	2.7	MODERATE
143	Bahamas	BS	2.6	MODERATE
144	Poland	PL	2.6	MODERATE
145	Slovakia	SK	2.5	MODERATE
146	Czech Republic	CZ	2.5	MODERATE
147	Slovenia	SI	2.5	MODERATE
148	Kuwait	KW	2.5	MODERATE
149	Bahrain	BH	2.4	MODERATE
150	Cyprus	CY	2.4	MODERATE
151	Estonia	EE	2.4	MODERATE
152	Latvia	LV	2.4	MODERATE
153	Lithuania	LT	2.4	MODERATE
154	Malta	MT	2.3	MODERATE
155	Portugal	PT	2.3	MODERATE
156	Qatar	QA	2.3	MODERATE
157	Barbados	BB	2.3	MODERATE
158	Seychelles	SC	2.3	MODERATE

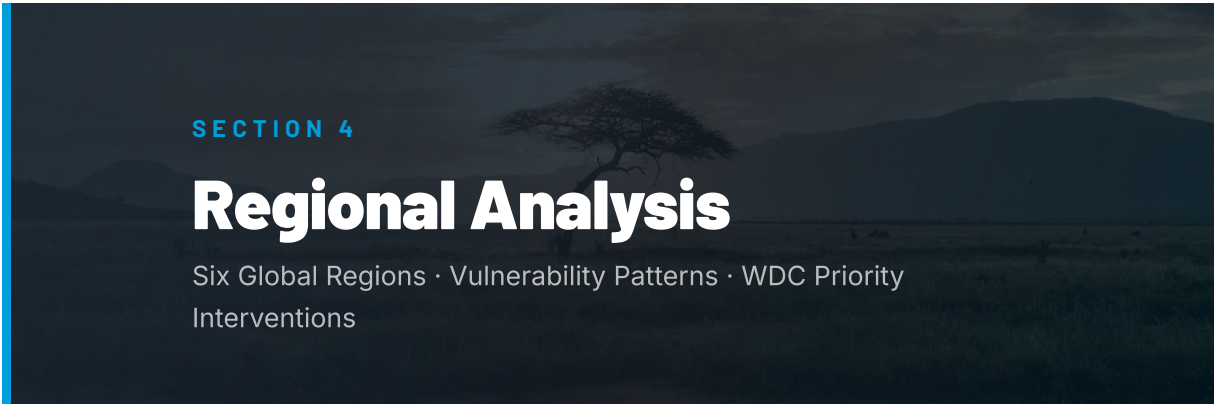
SECTION 3 · GLOBAL VULNERABILITY RANKINGS

Countries #159–#186 of
195

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
159	Spain	ES	2.2	MODERATE
160	Italy	IT	2.2	MODERATE
161	UAE	AE	2.2	MODERATE
162	South Korea	KR	2.2	MODERATE
163	Brunei	BN	2.2	MODERATE
164	Taiwan	TW	2.1	MODERATE
165	Belgium	BE	2.1	MODERATE
166	France	FR	2.1	MODERATE
167	Netherlands	NL	2.1	MODERATE
168	Austria	AT	2.1	MODERATE
169	Ireland	IE	2.1	MODERATE
170	Palau	PW	2.1	MODERATE
171	Nauru	NR	2.0	MODERATE
172	Singapore	SG	2.0	MODERATE
173	New Zealand	NZ	1.9	LOW
174	Iceland	IS	1.9	LOW
175	Switzerland	CH	1.8	LOW
176	Sweden	SE	1.8	LOW
177	Norway	NO	1.8	LOW
178	Denmark	DK	1.8	LOW
179	Finland	FI	1.8	LOW
180	Luxembourg	LU	1.7	LOW
181	Australia	AU	1.7	LOW
182	Canada	CA	1.7	LOW
183	United States	US	1.7	LOW
184	United Kingdom	GB	1.7	LOW
185	Germany	DE	1.6	LOW
186	Japan	JP	1.6	LOW

#	COUNTRY	ISO	GVI SC...	TIER
187	Liechtenstein	LI	1.4	LOW
188	San Marino	SM	1.4	LOW
189	Monaco	MC	1.4	LOW
190	Andorra	AD	1.4	LOW
191	Vatican City	VA	1.3	LOW
192	Cook Islands	CK	1.9	LOW
193	Niue	NU	1.9	LOW
194	Tokelau	TK	2.0	LOW

Sources: WDC GVI 2027 composite methodology. Individual dimension data from EM-DAT, ACLED, OCHA FTS, ND-GAIN, World Bank Fragile States Index, IPC, UNHCR GCRF, UNDP GII, UNICEF MICS, ITU. Scores reflect 2024–2026 vintage data. † = limited data confidence (3+ dimensions imputed).



SECTION 4

Regional Analysis

Six Global Regions · Vulnerability Patterns · WDC Priority Interventions



Sub-Saharan Africa

49 countries • Regional Average GVI: 6.1 • Highest concentration of Critical and Severe tier countries

Vulnerability Profile

Sub-Saharan Africa hosts 11 of the world's 13 Critical-tier countries. The region faces the intersection of climate vulnerability (D4 average: 7.8), food insecurity (D6 average: 7.4), and conflict (D2 average: 6.9). Despite considerable variation — from fragile states like South Sudan and DRC to more stable economies like Botswana and Mauritius — the structural drivers of vulnerability are deeply entrenched.

The Sahel sub-region (Mali, Niger, Burkina Faso, Chad, Mauritania) presents the world's most acute compound vulnerability: jihadist conflict, desertification, displacement, and food crisis converging simultaneously. The Horn of Africa (Ethiopia, Somalia, Eritrea, Djibouti) represents a second epicentre of interconnected crises amplified by seasonal drought.

Key Drivers

Climate & Food

The Sahel dries 0.3°C per decade faster than the global average. 282M people face acute food insecurity across the region — 47% of the global total.

Conflict Proliferation

Active armed group operations span 22 of 49 countries. Jihadist expansion in the Sahel has displaced 4.9M in the Mali-Burkina-Niger triangle alone.

Governance Gaps

16 countries in the region are classified as fragile or extremely fragile (FSI 2026). This erodes every dimension of protection simultaneously.

Top 10 Most Vulnerable (Africa)

#	COUNTRY	GVI	TIER
1	South Sudan	9.6	CRITICAL
2	Somalia	9.4	CRITICAL
3	DR Congo	9.1	CRITICAL
4	CAR	8.9	CRITICAL
5	Sudan	8.8	CRITICAL
6	Mali	8.4	CRITICAL
7	Niger	8.3	CRITICAL
8	Burkina Faso	8.2	CRITICAL
9	Ethiopia	7.8	SEVERE ..
10	Chad	7.7	SEVERE ..

WDC Priority Interventions – Sub-Saharan Africa

- **Sahel Vulnerability Belt:** Pre-positioning of early warning systems and pre-crisis food assistance across the Mali-Niger-Burkina triangle before each lean season (March–June)
- **Great Lakes Displacement Corridor:** Real-time displacement tracking and protection gap mapping across DRC-CAR-Sudan border zones

- **Horn of Africa Climate Resilience:** Community-level drought early warning and livestock protection programs in Somali region and the Ogaden
- **West Africa Child Protection:** Anti-trafficking networks along major migration corridors from Niger through Libya to the Mediterranean



Middle East & North Africa

20 countries • Regional Average GVI: 5.8 • Highest conflict intensity globally; compound displacement crises

Vulnerability Profile

MENA contains the highest average conflict score (D2: 7.4) of any region, driven by active wars in Yemen, Syria, Palestinian Territories, and Sudan's Darfur, alongside protracted fragility in Libya and Iraq. The region's oil-wealthy states (Qatar, UAE, Saudi Arabia) skew the regional average, masking extreme variation between states.

Water scarcity intersects with conflict across the entire region: 17 of 20 MENA countries face high or extreme water stress. Climate projections indicate the region will experience 20–30 additional days above 50°C annually by 2050, creating compound climate–conflict–displacement risk at unprecedented scale.

Top 10 Most Vulnerable (MENA)

#	COUNTRY	GVI	TIER
1	Yemen	9.3	CRITICAL
2	Syria	9.0	CRITICAL
3	Palestine	8.7	CRITICAL
4	Libya	7.3	SEVERE ..
5	Iraq	6.8	SEVERE ..
6	Lebanon	6.8	SEVERE ..
7	Egypt	4.6	ELEVATED
8	Morocco	4.5	ELEVATED
9	Jordan	4.3	ELEVATED
10	Iran	4.2	ELEVATED



South & Southeast Asia

25 countries • Regional Average GVI: 5.0 • World's highest disaster exposure; 60% of globally displaced persons

South and Southeast Asia present the world's most acute convergence of disaster risk (D1 average: 7.1) and population density. Bangladesh, Nepal, and the Philippines absorb a disproportionate share of global climate-related disasters. Myanmar's ongoing conflict (D2: 9) has produced 2.8M internally displaced persons. Pakistan, the region's largest fragile state, faces simultaneous flood, economic, and conflict risk. India's scale (1.4B population) means even moderate vulnerability scores translate to the world's largest absolute numbers of vulnerable people.



Latin America & Caribbean

33 countries • Regional Average GVI: 4.1 • Rising urban violence; Caribbean climate exposure; Venezuela crisis

Latin America and the Caribbean presents a distinct vulnerability pattern dominated by urban violence (D2 elevated), climate hazard exposure in the Caribbean (D1, D4 high in SIDS), and the Venezuelan displacement crisis (6.5M displaced — the region's largest). The Central American Northern Triangle (Guatemala, Honduras, El Salvador) scores consistently in the HIGH tier, driven by gang violence, food insecurity, and a migration crisis that shows no signs of abating. The Caribbean small island states face existential climate risk: Kiribati, Tuvalu, and the Marshall Islands (tracked in the Pacific cluster) score 10/10 on climate vulnerability.



Europe & Central Asia

54 countries • Regional Average GVI: 2.9 • Ukraine war dominates; Central Asia fragility; Balkans structural vulnerability

Europe and Central Asia is the most internally heterogeneous region in the GVI. Western Europe (GVI 1.6–2.2) anchors the Low and lower-Moderate tiers. Ukraine's ongoing war drives its Severe classification (GVI 6.5), representing the largest active displacement event in European history since 1945 (6.7M international refugees, 5.1M IDPs). Central Asian states — Tajikistan (5.2), Kyrgyzstan (5.1), Uzbekistan (3.8) — face compound fragility: authoritarian governance, water scarcity, climate exposure, and proximity to Afghanistan's conflict spillover. The Western Balkans cluster (Kosovo, Bosnia, Albania, Serbia) remains in the Elevated tier due to institutional fragility, unresolved post-conflict dynamics, and persistent poverty pockets.



Pacific & Oceania

14 countries • Regional Average GVI: 3.6 • Existential climate crisis; highest D4 scores globally

The Pacific presents a unique vulnerability signature: low conflict and socioeconomic scores, but the world's highest climate vulnerability (D4). Kiribati, Tuvalu, and the Marshall Islands score 10/10 on the climate dimension — the maximum — as sea-level rise poses an existential threat to their territorial integrity. These nations face a category of vulnerability not captured by conventional humanitarian frameworks: not crises they can recover from, but the permanent erasure of homeland. Papua New Guinea is the region's largest humanitarian challenge: extreme geographic fragmentation, tribal conflict, poor health infrastructure, and high disaster exposure (D1: 7) produce a sustained HIGH tier classification.

SECTION 5

Thematic Vulnerability Analysis

11 WDC PROTECT Campaign Dimensions · Cross-Country Rankings · 2027 Targets

Each WDC PROTECT campaign corresponds to a distinct dimension of human vulnerability. This section presents the thematic index for each campaign — the countries with the highest compound exposure on that specific dimension, the measurement framework WDC applies, and the 2027 strategic targets.

01 – Protect Women

Gender equality • Sexual violence prevention • Women's safety in crisis contexts

Highest Gender Vulnerability (D8)

Afghanistan (9) • Niger (9) • Chad (8) • Mali (9)
• South Sudan (9) • Somalia (9) • Guinea (8) •
Mauritania (7) • Pakistan (8) • Yemen (8)

Key Statistics

70% of disaster deaths globally are women • 3x
higher GBV risk in displacement • 200M+
women in regions with no legal GBV protection •
47% of humanitarian needs unmet for women-
led households

WDC 2027 Target: Publish the annual WDC Gender Risk Index for 100 communities; activate 3 corporate gender-impact CSR programs; submit gender-responsive disaster law briefs to 5 national parliaments.

02 – Protect Children

Child abuse • Trafficking • Exploitation • Online safety

Highest Child Vulnerability (D9)

Niger (10) • South Sudan (10) • Somalia (10) •
Mali (9) • Chad (9) • CAR (9) • Afghanistan (10) •
Sudan (9) • Ethiopia (9) • Malawi (8)

Key Statistics

426M children in high-intensity conflict zones • 1
in 4 children affected by humanitarian crisis •
40% of trafficking victims are children • 2B+
children lack safe digital environments

WDC 2027 Target: Publish WDC Child Vulnerability Index for 200 cities; fund 12 safe-space deployments within 72h of emergency declarations; submit child-protection clauses to 3 national DRR frameworks.

03 – Home for Everyone

Housing insecurity • Homelessness • Disaster displacement

Highest Displacement Risk (D7)

South Sudan (10) • Somalia (10) • Afghanistan (10) • Syria (10) • CAR (9) • Sudan (10) • Ukraine (9) • DR Congo (10) • Yemen (9) • Palestine (10)

Key Statistics

117M forcibly displaced (record) • 21.3M new disaster displacements in 2023 • 3× faster than population growth • \$25B annual funding gap

WDC 2027 Target: Activate real-time displacement tracking for all countries with D7 $\geq$ 8; publish WDC Displacement Protection Index; launch 2 corporate housing CSR programs.

04 – Girls in Tech

Digital access • STEM education • Technology careers

Highest Digital Exclusion (D10)

Niger (10) • Chad (10) • South Sudan (10) • Eritrea (10) • Burkina Faso (9) • Somalia (10) • Guinea-Bissau (10) • Guinea (9) • Mali (10) • CAR (10)

Key Statistics

327M fewer women than men with smartphone access • 22% of AI professionals are women • 3× higher earnings for digitally-skilled women • 2.4B still offline

WDC 2027 Target: Launch WDC Gender-Tech Gap Index; activate 500 digital literacy slots in 3 crisis-affected countries; secure 2 tech company pipeline partnerships.

05 – Climate Protect

Communities most vulnerable to climate disasters

Highest Climate Vulnerability (D4)

Kiribati (10) • Tuvalu (10) • Vanuatu (9) • Bangladesh (9) • Niger (9) • Maldives (9) • Solomon Islands (8) • Mozambique (9) • Nepal (8) • Chad (9)

Key Statistics

3.3–3.6B in highly climate-vulnerable contexts • 216M projected climate migrants by 2050 • 15× more likely displaced by climate than conflict • \$400B+ annual climate losses

WDC 2027 Target: Publish WDC Climate Vulnerability Index for 500 communities; deploy early warning systems in 5 countries with D4 $\geq$ 9; submit COP adaptation briefs; secure 2 green CSR programs.

06 – Protect People with Disabilities

Inclusive disaster preparedness • Accessibility

1.3B people (16% of humanity) live with disability. People with disabilities are 2–4× more likely to die in disasters. 90% in low-income countries lack access to disaster warning systems. WDC maps disability exclusion in preparedness systems and funds accessible infrastructure. **2027 Target:** Disability inclusion audit published for 20 countries; 3 accessible early warning systems deployed; mandatory inclusion clauses submitted to 2 national DRR laws.

07 – Safe Communities

Violence prevention • Community resilience

Post-disaster communities see a 3× spike in violent crime. 60% of post-conflict countries relapse within 5 years. \$14T is the annual global cost of violence. WDC maps violence risk alongside disaster exposure, funds community cohesion programs, and deploys Michael AI violence early warning. **2027 Target:** Community Safety Report published; violence-risk monitoring active in 8 post-disaster zones; 5 community resilience grants disbursed.

08 – Reproductive Health & Safety

Access, safety and informed choice in crisis contexts

500+ women die daily from preventable pregnancy complications in crises. 67% of maternal deaths occur in conflict-affected states. Only 1 in 4 humanitarian responses include reproductive health services. **2027 Target:** RH access report published; 4 emergency reproductive health kit deployments; advocacy submitted to SPHERE and UN inter-agency standards.

09 – Food Security

Protect vulnerable communities from hunger and famine

733M face hunger. 95% of acute food insecurity is in conflict or disaster-affected states. Pre-crisis intervention is 5× cheaper than famine response. WDC integrates IPC data, climate forecasts, and conflict indicators to generate food crisis early warnings. **2027 Target:** Quarterly food vulnerability reports; famine early warning alerts for all D6 ≥ 9 countries; 3 agri-food CSR programs activated.

10 – Digital Safety

Online exploitation • Misinformation • Digital vulnerability

80% of disasters involve significant misinformation. 1.8B children exposed to harmful online content annually. 40%+ of trafficking recruitment now via social media. \$6T annual cost of cybercrime. **2027 Target:** Digital Vulnerability Report published; Michael AI misinformation monitoring active for all major disasters; platform accountability briefs submitted to EU Digital Services Act review.

11 – Refugee & Displaced Protection

Protection and resilience for displaced populations

117M forcibly displaced (highest on record). 43.4M refugees and asylum seekers. Only 1% resettled annually. WDC tracks displacement in real time, maps protection gaps, and builds systems that protect people throughout their displacement journey. **2027 Target:** WDC Displacement Protection Index for all host countries; host community grant program in 4 countries; legal protection submissions to UNHCR ExCom and UNGA.

SECTION 6

Country Profiles – Top 20

Critical & Upper-Severe Tier Countries · Full Vulnerability Breakdown · WDC Priority Actions

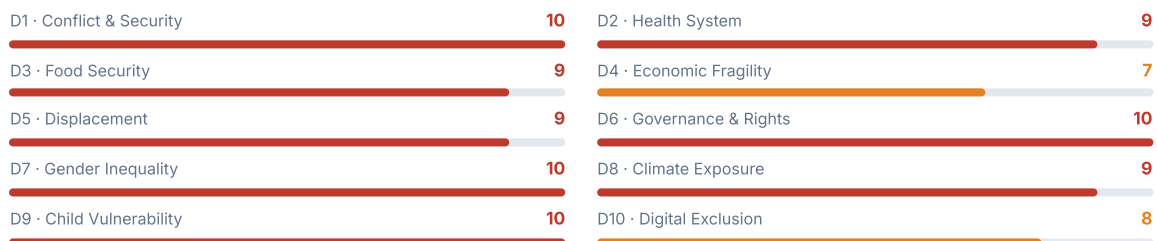
The following 20 country profiles represent the highest-ranked nations in the WDC Global Vulnerability Index 2027. Each profile includes the GVI composite score, individual dimension scores, a vulnerability narrative, and WDC's priority interventions for 2027.

1 Afghanistan

AF · South Asia

9.8

CRITICAL



Afghanistan holds the world's highest GVI score, with virtually no functioning health system, 23 million facing acute food insecurity, and total suppression of women's rights under Taliban governance. The compound, interlocking nature of all ten vulnerability dimensions makes Afghanistan the defining humanitarian emergency of the 2027 cycle.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

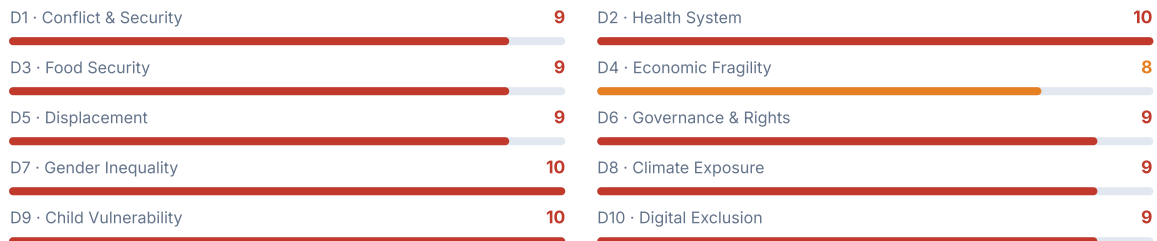
- Deploy WDC emergency health mission to 3 provinces
- Activate gender-monitoring protocol under Taliban governance
- Launch Afghanistan Food Crisis Early Warning with FEWS NET partners

2 South Sudan

SS · Sub-Saharan Africa

9.6

CRITICAL



South Sudan remains locked in chronic cycles of conflict and acute hunger, with 9.4 million people facing severe food insecurity and 4.1 million internally displaced. Subnational armed violence, ethnic tensions, and a near-total collapse of social services entrench multigenerational vulnerability across all ten dimensions.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

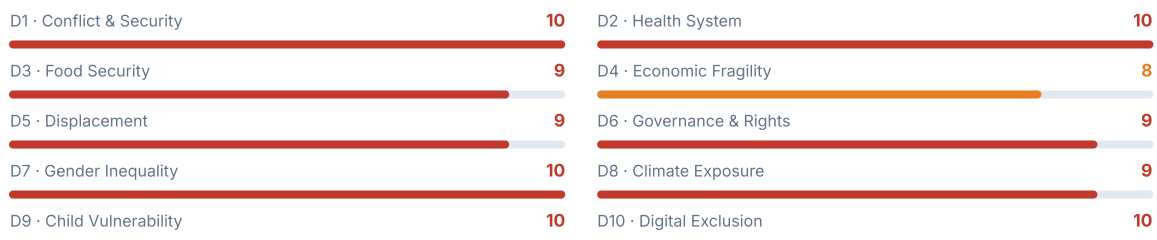
- Expand WDC Food Security Monitor to all 10 states
- Accelerate partner deployment of 50 emergency nutrition specialists
- Scale child-malnutrition surveillance in Unity and Jonglei states

3 Somalia

SO · Sub-Saharan Africa

9.4

CRITICAL



Decades of statelessness and Al-Shabaab insurgency have left Somalia in near-permanent humanitarian emergency, with drought and La Niña floods alternating to produce repeated famine-risk conditions. The absence of a unified governance structure renders aid coordination exceptionally difficult across all five federal member states.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

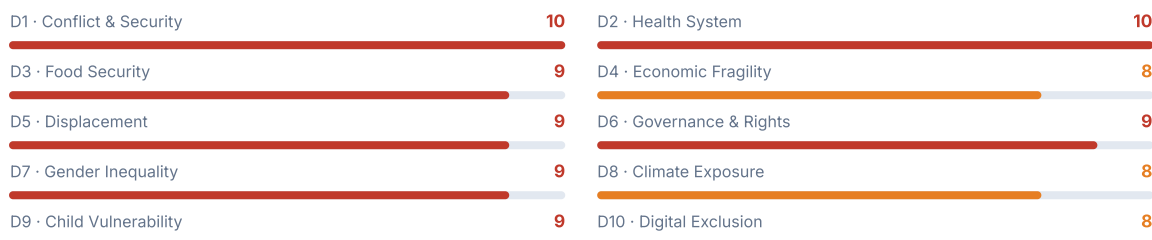
- Deploy WDC Rapid Response Unit for La Niña flood season
- Activate PROTECT-Children protocol in Mogadishu and Baidoa
- Establish digital early-warning node with OCHA Somalia

4 Yemen

YE · MENA

9.3

CRITICAL



The decade-long civil conflict has left 21 million Yemenis in humanitarian need, with cholera, diphtheria, and acute malnutrition remaining rampant as the health system operates at less than 50% capacity. A fragile ceasefire has not translated into sustained recovery or functional public services in most governorates.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

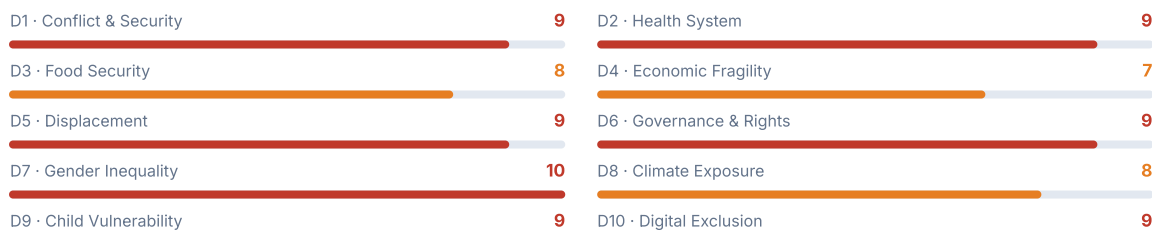
- Fund WDC Health System Rapid Assessment in Taiz and Aden
- Scale partner cholera-prevention missions
- Engage Houthi and government-held zone leads on civilian-safe corridor protocols

5 DR Congo

CD · Sub-Saharan Africa

9.1

CRITICAL



Eastern DRC's 100+ armed groups have generated Africa's largest internal displacement crisis at 7 million+ IDPs, while Ebola, cholera, and mpox co-circulate in overcrowded camps. Extractive mining wealth continues to finance armed actors rather than public services, creating a conflict-poverty trap across Kivu and Ituri.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

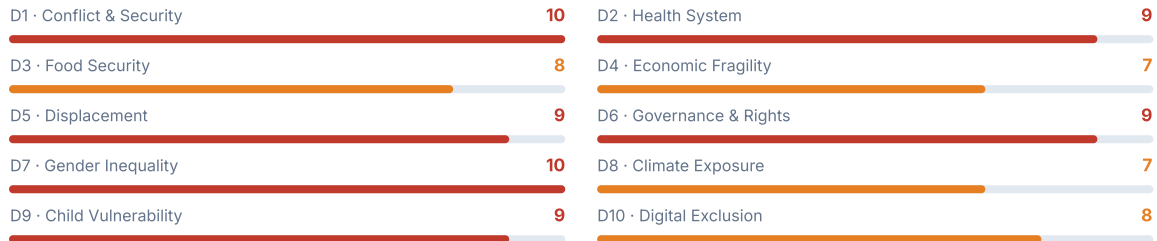
- Activate WDC Multi-Disease Surveillance Node for eastern provinces
- Expand displacement-profiling mission to South Kivu
- Convene corporate accountability roundtable on conflict mineral supply chains

6 Syria

SY · MENA

9.0

CRITICAL



Fourteen years of civil war and the 2023 earthquake have pushed Syria to a near-total infrastructure collapse, with 13.4 million in humanitarian need and over 7 million internally displaced — the world's largest sustained IDP crisis. Cross-line access for humanitarian convoys remains severely restricted across frontline governorates.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

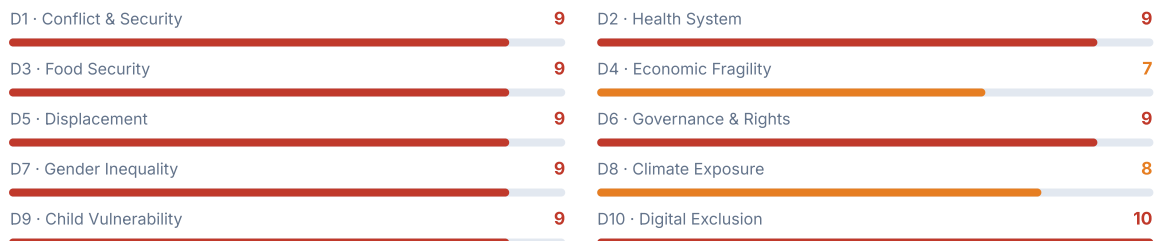
- Coordinate WDC Shelter & WASH rapid deployment in Aleppo and Idlib
- Activate earthquake recovery assessment mission
- Establish cross-line aid facilitation mechanism with UNOCHA Syria

7 Central African Republic

CF · Sub-Saharan Africa

8.9

CRITICAL



Armed group activity — including Wagner/Africa Corps-backed operations — continues to drive civilian displacement and atrocity crimes across the CAR, with one of the world's lowest per-capita health expenditures compounding structural fragility. Extreme digital exclusion leaves communities unable to receive early warnings or report protection incidents.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Launch WDC Armed Actor Monitoring Dashboard for CAR
- Deploy child-protection mission to Bangui and Bambari
- Activate digital-literacy pilot program in 3 major displacement camps

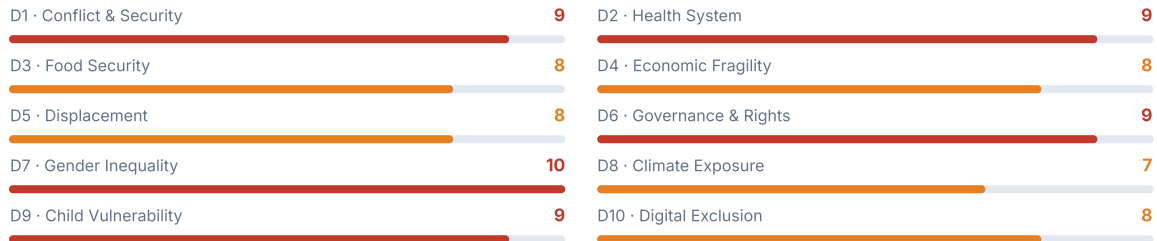
8

Sudan

SD · Sub-Saharan Africa

8.8

CRITICAL



The April 2023 conflict between the SAF and RSF triggered the world's single largest recent displacement crisis, generating 8+ million newly displaced persons with mass targeting of civilians in Khartoum and Darfur. All major relief corridors remain contested, making Sudan the most logistically complex humanitarian operation of 2027.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Activate WDC Sudan Crisis Tracker for Khartoum, North Darfur, and South Kordofan
- Deploy 30 emergency health workers
- Engage UN Sudan ceasefire commission on civilian corridor access protocols

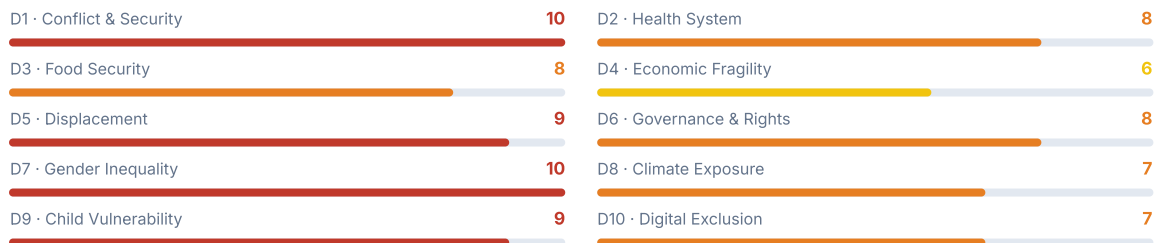
9

Palestinian Territories

PS · MENA

8.7

CRITICAL



The 2023–2024 Gaza conflict generated a catastrophic emergency with 1.9 million displaced within Gaza and the health system largely destroyed, as malnutrition and waterborne disease soared to famine-threshold levels. The West Bank faces simultaneous governance deterioration and settler-violence escalation requiring separate monitoring frameworks.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

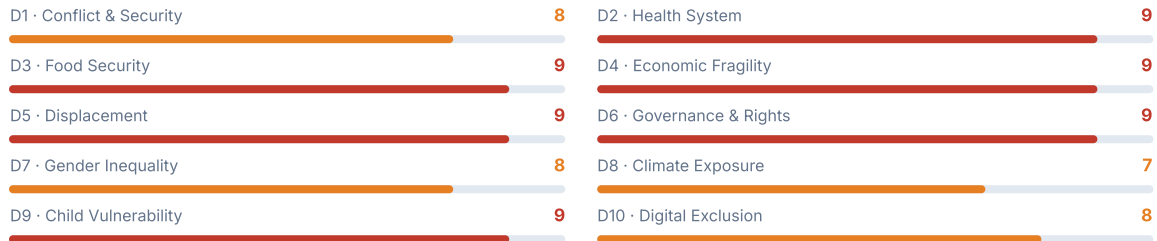
- Deploy WDC Medical Emergency Mission to Gaza through Rafah crossing
- Publish WDC Gaza Health Systems Destruction Report
- Scale partner food and water delivery in northern Gaza with UNRWA

10 Haiti

HT · Latin America & Caribbean

8.6

CRITICAL



Haiti has entered governance collapse following the 2021 presidential assassination and subsequent gang takeover of over 80% of Port-au-Prince, leaving 5.5 million in acute hunger with aid corridors systematically blocked. Gang violence has effectively displaced the state, making Haiti the most access-constrained humanitarian operation in the Western Hemisphere.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Activate WDC Gang-Violence Mapping Tool for metropolitan Port-au-Prince
- Partner with MSF for trauma surgery deployment
- Engage CARICOM on multilateral stabilization support framework

11 Mali

ML · Sub-Saharan Africa

8.5

CRITICAL



Following two coups and the MINUSMA withdrawal, Mali faces rapidly expanding jihadist insurgency in the centre and north, with civilian displacement doubling since 2021. Russia's Africa Corps presence has increased reports of civilian harm while reducing humanitarian access in areas of joint military operations.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Expand WDC Sahel Conflict Monitor to all northern Mali regions
- Activate gender-protection mission following MINUSMA departure
- Engage transition government on civilian harm-reduction protocols

12 Niger

NE · Sub-Saharan Africa

8.4

UPPER-SEVERE



Niger's 2023 military coup triggered ECOWAS sanctions that deepened pre-existing food and climate emergencies, as the Sahel's most climate-vulnerable state faces extreme child and gender vulnerabilities alongside a rapid escalation of JNIM activity. Digital exclusion — the worst in the region — blocks access to early-warning systems for over 80% of the rural population.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

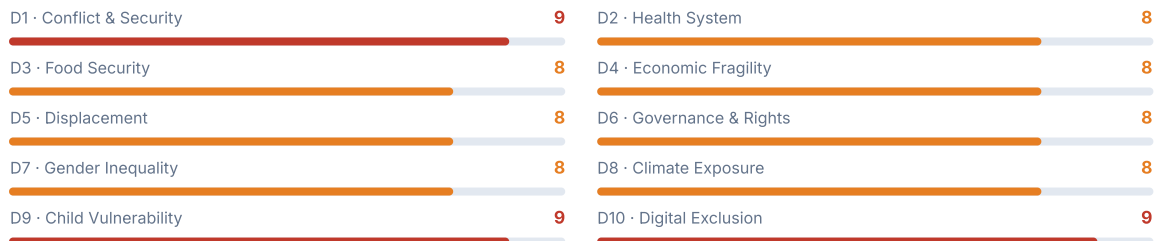
- Launch WDC Coup-Impact Assessment on humanitarian access
- Scale child malnutrition intervention in Zinder and Maradi
- Activate digital-exclusion task force for rural western populations

13 Burkina Faso

BF · Sub-Saharan Africa

8.3

UPPER-SEVERE



Junta governance and near-total exclusion of UN agencies from northern regions since 2024 have brought humanitarian visibility in Burkina Faso to a critical low, with populations in Nord and Sahel cut off from international aid. School closure has affected over 900,000 children, generating a lost-generation risk that extends far beyond the immediate conflict period.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

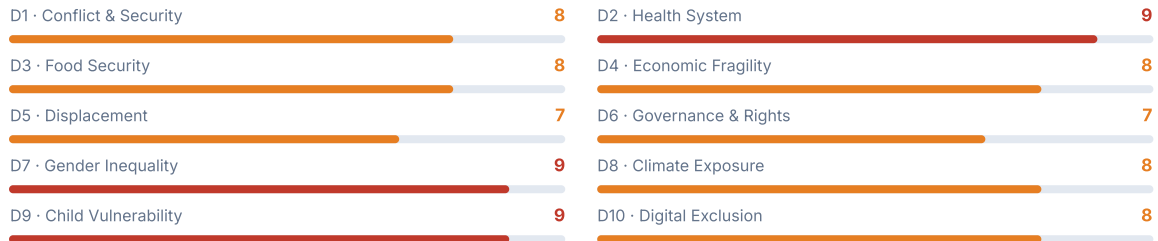
- Deploy WDC Closed-Access Monitoring Protocol for northern Burkina Faso
- Activate child-education emergency response in Djibo corridor
- Partner with local NGOs for food delivery operations

14 Ethiopia

ET · Sub-Saharan Africa

8.2

UPPER-SEVERE



Despite the 2022 Tigray peace agreement, Ethiopia's Amhara and Oromia regions face renewed armed violence, while drought across the south and east keeps 21 million in acute food insecurity. The combination of conflict displacement and climate shocks is outpacing Ethiopia's humanitarian response capacity in seven of eleven regions.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Activate WDC Amhara Crisis Monitor
- Scale food-security partnerships in Somali and Afar regions
- Launch gender-based violence response protocol for Oromia displacement sites

15 Chad

TD · Sub-Saharan Africa

8.1

UPPER-SEVERE



Chad hosts 1 million+ refugees from neighboring conflicts while managing its own Sahel-wide food crisis, as Lake Chad's shrinking basin eliminates livelihoods for millions of farmers and pastoralists. Extreme digital exclusion and one of the world's lowest literacy rates severely limit community resilience, early-warning access, and livelihood diversification options.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Expand WDC Lake Chad Basin early-warning system
- Activate child nutrition mission in BET and Ouaddaï regions
- Launch refugee-host community resilience assessment across three eastern provinces

16 Eritrea

ER · Sub-Saharan Africa

8.0

UPPER-SEVERE



Eritrea's indefinite national service system continues to drive one of Africa's largest per-capita exoduses, while near-total exclusion of international observers prevents accurate humanitarian assessments. Digital exclusion is the highest in Africa, blocking information access for a population that already has no independent media or civil society.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

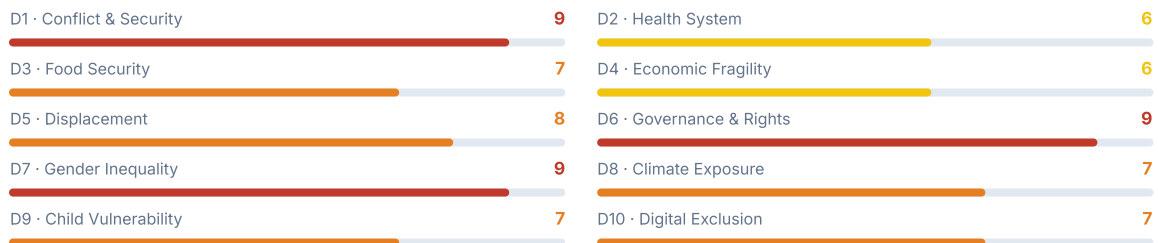
- Advocate for humanitarian-access agreement through AU mechanism
- Activate Diaspora Risk Mapping Tool for Eritrean communities abroad
- Publish closed-state monitoring brief via WDC Intelligence Division

17 Libya

LY · MENA

7.9

UPPER-SEVERE



Libya's parallel government crisis and arms embargo violations sustain a simmering conflict, while the 2023 Derna floods — killing 10,000+ in a preventable disaster — exposed catastrophic governance failure in infrastructure maintenance. Libya's role as a key migration transit corridor concentrates extreme vulnerability among intercepted migrants held in detention facilities.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

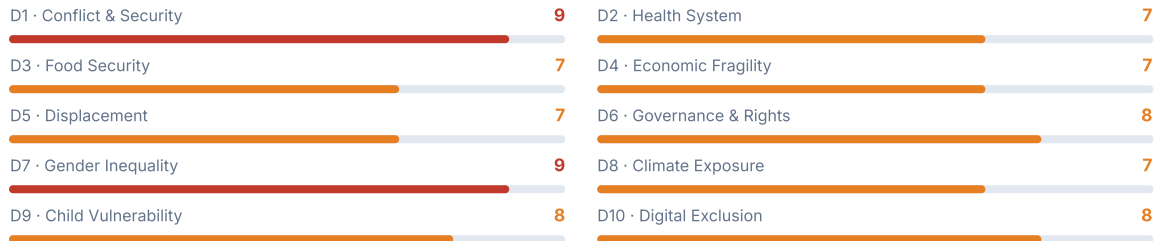
- Deploy WDC Post-Disaster Governance Assessment Mission to Derna
- Scale migrant-monitoring operations in Tripolitania and Cyrenaica
- Convene Libya-neighbours dialogue on border protection protocols

18 Myanmar

MM · South & Southeast Asia

7.8

UPPER-SEVERE



Since the February 2021 military coup, Myanmar has spiraled into multi-front civil war with 2+ million displaced civilians as People's Defence Forces and ethnic armed organizations contest territory across the country. The junta's documented use of airstrikes on civilian populations — schools, markets, hospitals — constitutes systematic violations of international humanitarian law.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Activate WDC Myanmar Airstrikes Database and civilian harm tracker
- Expand displacement tracking in Chin, Kachin, and Sagaing regions
- Submit evidence brief to ASEAN Inter-Parliamentary Myanmar Caucus

19 Guinea-Bissau

GW · Sub-Saharan Africa

7.7

UPPER-SEVERE



Chronic political instability — nine coups or coup attempts since independence — has prevented sustained investment in health, education, or economic development, while narco-trafficking routes through the country systematically undermine governance capacity. The population remains among West Africa's most food-insecure, with structural vulnerabilities amplified by a complete absence of resilience-building infrastructure.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Launch WDC Political-Stability Index for Guinea-Bissau and Sahel Coast
- Activate child-health mission in Gabu region
- Partner with UNODC on narco-governance risk mapping

20 Burundi

BI · Sub-Saharan Africa

7.6

UPPER-SEVERE



Burundi's post-2015 political crisis left a legacy of systematic human rights abuses and repression of civil society, blocking reporting on humanitarian conditions and deterring international investment. Food insecurity affects 3+ million people, and digital exclusion limits both livelihood diversification and community access to emergency information and early warnings.

WDC 2027 PRIORITY ACTIONS

- Scale WDC Food Security Alert System in Kirundo and Cibitoke provinces
- Activate civil-society protection protocol in partnership with regional human rights bodies
- Launch digital-access intervention in 5 provincial capitals



SECTION 7

Policy Recommendations

Evidence-Based Action Framework · Five Stakeholder Categories
· 2027–2030 Horizon

The WDC Global Vulnerability Index is not a passive ranking — it is a call to action. The evidence assembled across 195 countries and 10 dimensions points to a concentrated, preventable set of failures. The following recommendations are directed at five stakeholder groups whose decisions determine whether vulnerability declines or compounds.

01 – UN Member States & National Governments

- Adopt the GVI as a national risk planning baseline — integrate into National Adaptation Plans (NAPs) and National Disaster Risk Reduction Plans (NDRRPs)
- Legislate mandatory disability-inclusion clauses in all disaster risk management frameworks by 2028
- Establish predictive (not reactive) humanitarian financing mechanisms: release pre-positioned funds when WDC GVI + IPC Phase 3 threshold is crossed, not after famine is declared
- Ratify and implement UNDRR Sendai Framework targets with gender-disaggregated baselines for all D1–D9 indicators
- Mandate reproductive health inclusion in national emergency preparedness plans (aligned with SPHERE Minimum Standards)

02 – International NGOs & Humanitarian Actors

- Use GVI Critical and Severe-tier countries as the primary prioritisation framework for field office deployment and early action budget allocation
- Adopt WDC's community-level vulnerability mapping methodology: do not operate at national-level analysis when district-level data is available
- Partner with WDC's Roster system to deploy certified humanitarian professionals within 72 hours of a D1+D7 trigger event
- Share disaggregated programme data with WDC for integration into the next GVI edition — filling the current gap in D8 (Gender) and D9 (Child) primary data
- Advocate collectively for the inclusion of GVI community-level scores in OCHA Humanitarian Response Plans

03 – Corporate Partners & CSR Investors

The GVI creates a fundamentally different corporate conversation: instead of generic humanitarian donations, WDC offers named, verified, measurable protection outcomes in specific communities ranked by evidence.

- Align ESG and CSR strategies with GVI Critical-tier countries — WDC can structure *named* impact packages with annual outcome reporting
- Agricultural and food companies: fund WDC food security pre-crisis intervention programs in $D6 \geq 8$ countries — the 5:1 cost ratio of prevention over response is documented
- Technology and telecommunications companies: close the D10 digital exclusion gap through Girls in Tech and Digital Safety partnerships in the bottom 30 countries by internet penetration
- Real estate and construction companies: co-fund the WDC Displacement Protection Index and commit to named shelter projects in $D7 \geq 9$ communities
- Healthcare and pharmaceutical companies: fund reproductive health (D8 compound with D3) emergency kit pre-positioning in the 10 countries with highest combined gender and humanitarian risk

04 – Technology Companies & AI Platforms

- Integrate WDC's Michael AI disaster intelligence feed into social media crisis response protocols — particularly for misinformation detection (D10 compound indicator)
- Build digital safety curriculum partnerships with WDC in the 30 countries with $D10 \geq 8$ — digital exclusion is a protection crisis, not just a market gap
- Commit to platform transparency obligations in disaster contexts: share aggregated, anonymised data on content patterns in active disaster zones with WDC's Michael AI intelligence team
- Fund WDC's Digital Safety campaign to develop AI-powered misinformation detection systems calibrated to low-bandwidth, non-English crisis contexts (Sahel, Horn of Africa)
- Make disaster early warning information freely accessible via APIs to all humanitarian actors — no paywalls on life-saving data

05 – Bilateral Donors & Foundations

- Shift from crisis-reactive to vulnerability-anticipatory funding: allocate 15% of humanitarian budgets to countries in GVI Elevated or High tier *before* crisis onset
- Fund the WDC GVI Annual Publication as a public global intelligence good — the \$2M annual production cost is a fraction of a single emergency response
- Require GVI alignment in all humanitarian and development grant applications — grantees should demonstrate how their work reduces scores in specific GVI dimensions
- Prioritise multi-year, flexible funding for Civil Society Organisations working in Critical and Severe-tier countries — short-term project cycles are incompatible with protracted crisis response
- Fund WDC's Roster deployment system as a rapid-response surge capacity mechanism — humanitarian professionals deployable within 72 hours represent the highest-leverage

SECTION 8

Appendix

Glossary • Data Sources • Methodology Notes • WDC Contact Information

A. Glossary of Key Terms

TERM	DEFINITION
GVI	Global Vulnerability Index — WDC's composite annual assessment of country-level exposure to 10 dimensions of humanitarian vulnerability, scored 1–10.
Dimension Score	The normalised score (1–10) for a country on a single vulnerability dimension, derived from min-max normalisation of raw source data across all 195 countries.
IPC Phase	Integrated Food Security Phase Classification — the global standard for food crisis severity (Phase 1: Minimal → Phase 5: Catastrophe/Famine).
IDP	Internally Displaced Person — a person forced to flee their home but who remains within their own country's borders.
MENA	Middle East and North Africa — the regional classification used in WDC's analytical framework.
Compound Vulnerability	The intersection of two or more vulnerability dimensions simultaneously in the same community — the primary focus of WDC's intervention model.
Michael AI	WDC's proprietary disaster intelligence platform — integrates satellite data, ACLED conflict events, GDACS alerts, UN agency feeds, and weather models to generate real-time vulnerability assessments.
Pre-Crisis Intervention	Humanitarian or development action taken at IPC Phase 2–3 (before famine/emergency), when the cost-effectiveness of action is 5× higher than emergency response.
SITREP	Situation Report — a standardised periodic assessment of a humanitarian situation, produced by WDC for each of its 11 PROTECT campaigns.
Tier Classification	WDC's five-level classification of country vulnerability: Critical (GVI ≥ 8.0), Severe (6.5–7.9), High (5.0–6.4), Elevated (3.5–4.9), Moderate (2.0–3.4), Low (<2.0).

B. Primary Data Sources

DIMENSION	PRIMARY SOURCE	SECONDARY SOURCE	VINTAGE
D1 Disaster Risk	EM-DAT International Disaster Database	GDACS, UNDRR	2020–2026
D2 Conflict	ACLED Armed Conflict Location & Event Data	Uppsala UCDP, SIPRI	2024–2026
D3 Humanitarian Need	OCHA Financial Tracking Service (FTS)	OCHA HNO/HRP documents	2025–2026
D4 Climate	Notre Dame ND-GAIN Country Index	IPCC AR6, World Bank Clim...	2024–2026
D5 Socioeconomic	Fund for Peace Fragile States Index	World Bank HDI, UNDP HDR	2025–2026
D6 Food Security	IPC Global Platform	WFP VAM, FEWS NET	2025–2026
D7 Displacement	UNHCR Global Trends Report	IDMC Global Displacement	2025–2026
D8 Gender	UNDP Gender Inequality Index	OECD SIGI, WHO GBV data	2025–2026

DIMENSION	PRIMARY SOURCE	SECONDARY SOURCE	VINTAGE
D9 Child	UNICEF MICS + State of the World's Children	WHO Child Mortality Estim...	2024–2026
D10 Digital	ITU Digital Development Dashboard	GSMA Mobile Index, World ...	2025–2026

C. Methodology Notes

Data Imputation

Countries with missing data for a specific dimension are assigned the regional median of countries in the same World Bank income group. Countries with 3 or more imputed dimensions are flagged with † in the main rankings table and should be interpreted with caution. Currently 14 countries carry this flag, primarily small island states and closed societies (Eritrea, North Korea, Turkmenistan).

Score Stability

GVI scores are recalculated annually on a fixed cycle (Q3 data freeze, Q4 publication). Year-on-year changes of less than 0.3 points are within the margin of data revision uncertainty and should not be interpreted as meaningful change. Changes of 0.5+ indicate structural shifts requiring analytical attention. The largest single-year jump in GVI history was Sudan's +2.1 movement in 2023–2024 (conflict onset).

Scope Exclusions

Territories without UN member state status (Western Sahara, Kosovo*, Taiwan*, Palestine*) are tracked but not included in the official 193-member ranking. They appear as supplementary entries. *Kosovo and Taiwan are included in WDC's extended 195-country dataset as analytically significant entities.

D. WDC PROTECT – Partnership & Contact

Campaign Partnerships

WDC offers seven structured partnership tiers across all 11 PROTECT campaigns: Campaign Partner, Data Partner, Technology Partner, Research Partner, Corporate Champion, Founding Sponsor, and Policy Partner. Each tier includes defined deliverables, naming rights, and annual impact reporting.

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GVI Data Licensing

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